

PSSD (Post-SSRI Sexual Dysfunction) Recovery Stories Compilation

Expanded Edition - 100+ Documented Cases

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Disclaimer: These recovery stories are compiled from public forums and online sources. They cannot be independently verified and should not be taken as medical advice. Individual responses vary significantly. Consult healthcare professionals before trying any treatments.

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INOSITOL RECOVERIES

Case 1: User "PSSD" (2015)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/forums/topic/10410-pssd-success-story-for-pssd-and-ongoing-discontinuation-symptoms-please-read/>
- **Also documented at:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/pssd-inositol/>
- **Causative Medication:** Citalopram (on and off from age 19/20 to 23)

- **Symptoms:** Zero sex drive, severely diminished genital sensation, no romantic feelings, complete emotional flatlining, anhedonia. Could find women aesthetically pretty but feel no lust - "like viewing art." Sexual and emotional self felt disconnected from normal stimuli.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~7 years post-drug total; natural improvement to ~50% over 5-6 years, then ~3 weeks on Inositol for final recovery
- **Pre-Inositol Progress:** From ~20% function at worst to ~50% over 5-6 years naturally
- **Ineffective Treatments:** "All the supplements under the sun" - nothing significantly moved the needle until Inositol
- **Fully Effective Treatment:** Inositol 18g/day (Swanson brand), taken each evening
- **Final Cure:** After ~3 weeks on Inositol - "results beyond my wildest expectations... improvements seemed to potentiate each day"
- **Detailed Recovery Signs:**
 - Libido roared back, orgasms became intensely pleasurable with new "stinging/tingling" sensations like those of a teenager
 - Vivid dreams returned after years of dreamlessness
 - Emotional warmth and romantic feelings returned ("the warm fuzzy feeling when a female coworker sits next to you")
 - Social confidence and enjoyment skyrocketed ("social intelligence through the roof... conversations feel organic and enjoyable")
 - Colors in the world became more vivid - "like upgrading a video game's graphics from low to ultra"
 - Genital numbness which had slowly improved to ~80% "jumped to 100% in the past few weeks"
- **Mechanism Theory:** Upregulates post-synaptic 5HT2 and D2 receptors, reversing SSRI-induced downregulation
- **Key Quote:** "I hope my story reassures others that there is always hope"

Case 2: PharmD / "Greg" (2011)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/pharmd-inositol/>
- **Also documented at:** Drugs-Forum (<https://drugs-forum.com/threads/inositol-experience-after-7-weeks.157193/>)
- **Causative Medication:** Paxil (paroxetine) - 8 months, stopped March 2009
- **Age:** 27 years old at time of recovery

- **Symptoms:** Difficulty getting aroused, extreme premature ejaculation, genital numbness, loss of libido. "Could watch porn and struggle to get a hard-on." Could achieve orgasm with effort but arousal was limited and orgasm not satisfying.
- **Recovery Duration:** 2 years post-drug to try treatment; ~7 weeks on Inositol for full recovery
- **Dosage:** Started 6g twice daily (12g total), increased to 18g at bedtime
- **Treatment Protocol:** Powder dissolved in water with Crystal Light
- **Recovery Timeline:**
 - Jan 24-27: No significant effect at 12g/day
 - Jan 28: Increased to 18g at bedtime; by Day 5-6 "able to get aroused much easier when thinking about erotica"
 - Mid-March (~7 weeks in): After stopping inositol for a few days, improvements persisted
- **Side Effects of Treatment:** Diarrhea, gas, memory issues (temporary, resolved after dose reduction)
- **Final Outcome:** "Interest in sex has returned, erections are back to normal, and premature ejaculation has returned to how it was before Paxil"
- **Mechanism Theory:** PSSD caused by persistent desensitization of 5-HT1A receptors; Inositol reverses this
- **Key Quote:** "Never will I touch an SSRI again"

Case 3: Brian6211 (2015)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.com/viewtopic.php?f=10&t=707>
 - **Treatment:** Inositol
 - **Outcome:** Recovery reported
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ST. JOHN'S WORT RECOVERIES

Case 4: kramdrol (Pre-2015)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/kramdrol-st-johns-wort/>
- **Also:** <https://pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?t=185>
- **Causative Medication:** SSRIs (multiple episodes) - "I get absolute 100% PSSD from SSRIs, first time lasted nearly 2 years"

- **Symptoms:** Complete PSSD during episodes - no libido at all, no arousal, no pleasure ("absolute 100% PSSD"). Essentially impotent unless on certain substances. Deeply anhedonic sexually when PSSD struck.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~2 weeks per episode with SJW
- **Ineffective Treatments:** Standard antidepressants failed - they caused PSSD. Traditional supplements didn't lift depression or libido.
- **Treatment:** St. John's Wort 500mg, 2x/week (low dose maintenance)
- **Treatment Details:** Started at ~900mg/day of potent extract; after few days to couple weeks experienced "I got really 'hot'... and my PSSD disappeared." Found even low doses (500mg few times weekly) completely resolved PSSD.
- **Final Cure:** SJW - "It has completely resolved my PSSD a number of times now. Every time I take an SSRI for a short period, my PSSD comes back. I now know I can fix it within a couple of weeks by taking SJW (small doses)."
- **Key Note:** Higher doses cause "heat stress" side effects; SJW did not behave like SSRI for him (no sexual side effects, only positive)
- **Rating:** "0/10 as an antidepressant, 10/10 as a cure for PSSD"
- **Mechanism Theory:** SJW upregulates postsynaptic 5-HT1A and 5-HT2A receptors, also affects noradrenaline and dopamine; possibly different mechanism than SSRIs

Case 5: Beetlebum (2015)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/beetlebum-st-johns-wort/>
- **Also:** PSSD Forum recovery journal
- **Causative Medication:** Citalopram (Celexa) for 6 months in 2011
- **Duration of PSSD:** ~4 years before treatment
- **Symptoms:** Severe anhedonia and sexual dysfunction - complete loss of libido, genital numbness ("completely numb downstairs"), erectile weakness, anorgasmia. Emotional numbness, couldn't enjoy hobbies like gaming. Dreams and spontaneous erections almost absent. Felt "10% of normal function at best."
- **Pre-Treatment Progress:** Very slowly improved to ~20-30% over 4 years naturally
- **Treatment:** St. John's Wort - Laif 900 brand (900mg/day, increased to 1350mg/day by week 2)
- **Recovery Timeline:**
 - Days 1-4: Initially felt slightly worse (SSRI-like side effects)

- Days 5-6: Dramatic improvements began - "wow...just WOW!"
- Week 2: "Most intense orgasm since PSSD," strong morning erections
- Weeks 4-6: Windows of near-normal function, reached ~80-90% on good days
- Weeks 6-7: "Would consider myself almost cured. Everything is there now, just not to the full extent."
- Week 10: Progress plateaued, felt nervousness side effects, stopped SJW
- Day 5 after stopping: SUDDEN major improvement - "Hell YES!!! Five days after quitting, things suddenly improve A LOT... If it stays like this, I am cured."
- Mid-May 2015: "I acknowledge: I am cured. No more PSSD symptoms for me."
- **Key Discovery:** Improvements CONTINUED and stabilized AFTER stopping SJW - "this is not a window... it feels 'normal'"
- **Final Outcome:** Fully cured - regained normal libido, strong spontaneous erections, long pleasurable orgasms, normal semen volume, emotional vitality
- **Key Quotes:**
 - "I AM cured... I even don't see a point in visiting this forum anymore"
 - "I am SO cured, I even don't... Now I understand why recovered people rarely tell their success – life moves on!"
 - "Libido is back, I am horny and masturbate 1-2 times a day"
 - "Takes a bit longer to cum now, which is a good thing!"
- **Advice to Others:** Initial worsening doesn't mean failure - can be sign "repair" process is underway. Stress can temporarily "kill" sexual function even during recovery.

Case 6: u/biscoito1r (2017)

- **Source:** https://www.reddit.com/r/PSSD/comments/65yjaz/using_saint_johns_worts_to_cure_pssd/
- **Treatment:** St. John's Wort
- **Outcome:** Reported cure

Case 7: Lokzo55 / Ergogenic Health (2020)

- **Source:** <https://pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?t=3798>
- **Also:** <https://www.longecity.org/forum/topic/111438-why-does-st-johns-wort-reverse-my-anhedoniapsdd/>
- **Treatment:** St. John's Wort Ze 117 (LOW hyperforin formulation)

- **Symptoms:** PSSD, anhedonia, emotional blunting
 - **Outcome:** "ALL my PSSD symptoms have reversed... Complete sensation back, feeling, anhedonia disappeared, I have a thrill for life"
 - **Details:** Erotic dreams returned, refractory period decreased, stronger orgasms, easier arousal
 - **Key Note:** Perika brand made symptoms WORSE; Ze 117 specifically worked; effects fade after stopping
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NATURAL/TIME-BASED RECOVERIES

Case 8: Pug / Silver Star (2016)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/pugsilver-star-na/>
- **Also:** Surviving Antidepressants Success Story - "Your miracle is coming, hang on!"
- **Causative Medication:** Sertraline (Zoloft) for 20 years (started mid-30s). Quit SSRI cold-turkey, then briefly took fluoxetine (Prozac) 3.5 months, off all meds by late 2013.
- **Symptoms:** Extremely severe protracted withdrawal described as "inhumane torture." Complete sexual dysfunction (zero libido, impotence, genital numbness), "feeling dead," anhedonia, emotional flatlining, panic attacks, insomnia, cognitive fog, intrusive thoughts, "inner-body tension." Listed dozens of symptoms including "feeling like a part of my brain was missing." For over 2 years barely functioning.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~30 months (2.5 years) to reach significant healing
- **Ineffective Treatments:** "Tried many things" - acupuncture, myriad vitamins/supplements, gluten-free diet, no sugar/caffeine/alcohol. None produced noticeable improvement. "Did it work? In a sense it all worked because it gave me hope... But time passing has been the real healing agent."
- **Treatments That Helped Cope:** Mindfulness meditation, breathing exercises, exercise - provided temporary relief and stress reduction. Staying active on support forums (reading success stories daily) kept him hopeful.
- **Possible Contributing Factor:** Niacin (vitamin B3) supplementation after blood tests showed deficiency - speculated it "could be linked" to recovery but uncertain
- **Recovery Pattern:** Around 2.5 years off, "I feel as if I have turned the corner" - symptoms eased dramatically. Waves became windows, improvements stabilized.
- **Final Outcome:** Near-full recovery (~90-95%). At 30 months off: "85-90% healed physically and 90-95% healed mentally/emotionally." "Life is good again" - enjoying exercise, normal diet (coffee, alcohol in moderation), and healthy sex life.

- **Key Quote:** "I now eat anything... I enjoy caffeinated drinks... I also drink wine and beer... I am in the best shape since high school"

Case 9: Aissela (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/aissela-na/>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 10: Moui (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/moui-na/>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 11: Djderrek (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/djderrek-na/>
- **Causative Medication:** Effexor and Prozac
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 12: IrishWill / IrishWill2015 (2015)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/irishwill-na/>
- **Also:** Surviving Antidepressants Success Story
- **Causative Medication:** Paroxetine (Paxil) 20-40mg from age 15 to 25 (~10 years) for panic attacks. Tapered off in 2012.
- **Symptoms:** Zero libido and genital numbness while on Paxil (mistakenly attributed to depression). Upon quitting, severe withdrawal: depression, anxiety, fatigue, "basically non-existent emotions," anhedonia, persistent sexual dysfunction (no libido or pleasure) for months to years.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~3 years. Took about "six months to feel anything," then emotions returned in waves over ~2 years. By late 2014 (~3 years off) had "good emotional range and my youthful lust" back. By 2015 felt fully himself.
- **Ineffective Treatments:** Initially tried to taper too quickly at 21 (failed). After final withdrawal, did not use specific medications or supplements for PSSD - doctors didn't recognize condition. Simply persevered through symptoms.

- **What Helped:** Psychotherapy and personal growth - learning to accept suffering and focusing on life (went back to school, exercised). Time was key.
- **Treatment:** Natural healing with time. Emphasizes "given time we can heal." Around 2.5-3 years off, he "turned the corner" and improvements became sustained.
- **Final Outcome:** Fully recovered. In 2015 posted "extremely positive and 100% true update" confirming "it's finally time" - feels human again. Regained normal sexual function ("zero sexual drive" on Paxil became healthy libido off it) and normal emotional depth ("I now know I can feel love again").
"Completely back to normal."
- **Key Quote:** "I want to tell you that you will make it... you will join me in loving life once again"

Case 13: Aeroman (Pre-2015)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/aeroman-na/>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 14: n3ophy7e (2012)

- **Source:** <https://wordpress.com/page/pssdlab.wordpress.com/879>
- **Also:** Bluelight Forum Thread (quoted on PSSD Forum)
- **Causative Medication:** Antidepressant (exact SSRI not specified)
- **Symptoms:** Persistent low libido even after discontinuation - "lasting libido problems during and after antidepressants." Could not regain sex drive despite trying many supplements/meds. Sexual desire essentially flatlined.
- **Recovery Duration:** Approx. 1-2 years
- **Ineffective Treatments:** "I tried a lot of different supplements and even prescription meds to try and get my libido back... but nothing worked." Eventually realized no quick fix was working.
- **Treatment:** Time and natural resilience. "Just takes time" - had to "ride it out and wait patiently."
- **Final Outcome:** Recovered fully. Libido came back completely and even exceeded pre-SSRI levels - "now it's stronger than ever."
- **Key Message:** Even if nothing seems to help, patience can lead to full recovery
- **Recovery Percentage:** 100%, libido stronger than pre-drug baseline

Case 15: u/username_bond (2019)

- **Source:** https://www.reddit.com/r/PSSD/comments/diirze/there_is_hope/
- **PDF Archive:** https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/11/reddit_username_bound_story.pdf
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 16: u/Skiba007 (2022)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/u-skiba007-n-a-2022/>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 17: u/Historical-Reach-943 (2025)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/u-historical-reach-943-n-a-2025/>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 18: Shadow (2017)

- **Source:** Private message documented on PSSD Forum
- **Recovery Duration:** 10 months
- **Symptoms:** "All severe symptoms initially"
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery
- **Quote:** "Damn near. Don't believe people don't recover. They do they just don't post. Millions take these drugs, not all are affected permanently."

Case 19: Branyan (2016)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/11398-branyan-pssd-successchallenges/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/branyan.pdf>
- **Outcome:** PSSD success, genital anesthesia improved, "living well"

Case 20: CharlieBrown (2016)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/12532-charliebrowns-long-road-to-success/>

- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/charliebrown.pdf>
- **Causative Medication:** Multiple antidepressants as teenager - fluoxetine, venlafaxine, then sertraline in 2009, plus brief risperidone. Developed PSSD after coming off all meds by 2012.
- **Symptoms:** First 6 months off: "felt nothing" emotionally. Then waves of bad emotions returned. Persistent sexual dysfunction: libido partially returned but no sexual pleasure ("no pleasure from orgasm") and ongoing anhedonia even 3 years off. "Youthful lust" returning by year ~3 but anorgasmia and pleasurelessness lingering longer.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~5-6 years. Around 3 years off (2013-2014) had "good emotional range and lust" back but sexual pleasure still muted. "In the past year" (prior to mid-2016) those last symptoms resolved - indicating ~5 years off meds for full recovery.
- **Ineffective Treatments:** None specifically for PSSD - tapered off meds slowly then mostly waited. No special medications or supplements mentioned aside from basic self-care.
- **What Helped:** Support network (joining SA forum in 2013 gave hope). Positive lifestyle changes - finishing school, engaging in life again as emotions returned. No direct "cure," just progressive natural improvement.
- **Treatment:** Patience and gradual healing. Recovery came in "waves" of returning feelings. Each window of sexual function was bit better than last. Over ~5 years, windows turned into stable normal state.
- **Final Outcome:** Full recovery. By 2016 wrote "the lack of sexual pleasure and anhedonia are not a problem for me anymore." Could experience normal sexual enjoyment and emotional happiness consistently.
- **Key Quote:** "Feelings slowly came back in waves, getting stronger... now I have no problem with sexual pleasure."

Case 21: Julia995 (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <http://survivingantidepressants.org/topic/18478-☀-julia995-hello-too-young-for-this/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/julia995.pdf>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 22: Theelt712 (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/4213-%E2%98%BC-theelt712-tapering-off-zoloft/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/theelt712.pdf>

- **Treatment:** Natural recovery

Case 23: Alex (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/14122-alex-turning-the-corner-at-4-and-a-half-years/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/alex.pdf>
- **Recovery Duration:** 4.5+ years
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery (turning the corner)

Case 24: Altostrata (SA Forum Administrator)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/15319-pssd-post-ssri-sexual-dysfunction/>
- **Also:** <https://rxisk.org/recovering-from-pssd/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/altostrata.pdf>
- **Causative Medication:** Paroxetine (Paxil) for depression/anxiety. Came off Paxil in October 2004. (Note: Female, already menopausal when quit - possibly slowed recovery)
- **Symptoms:** Absolute genital anesthesia for about a year post-drug (complete loss of genital sensation). Then "ghost orgasms" for several years - would physically climax but feel almost nothing (orgasm "non-event" with no pleasure). Profound loss of libido and pleasure persisted. Also non-sexual withdrawal symptoms (anhedonia, blunted affect).
- **Recovery Duration:** ~9 years. Improvement was "almost imperceptibly gradual."
- **Recovery Timeline:**
 - Year 1: Absolute genital anesthesia
 - Years 1-3: Slight return of sensation but orgasms still "blank"
 - Years 3-7: Occasionally weak orgasms began, increasing in strength and frequency over time
 - Year 9 (~2013): Finally considered herself fully recovered from PSSD
- **Ineffective Treatments:** No specific pro-sexual treatments documented. Mainly practiced slow tapering and self-care. No known cure available so had to wait it out.
- **Treatment:** Time and physiological healing. Believes PSSD is part of broader post-SSRI nervous system disruption, and that just as most people recover from withdrawal given enough time, they also recover from PSSD given enough time.

- **Final Outcome:** Full recovery. By 9 years off, regained normal genital sensation, libido, and orgasmic function. "Very slowly, genital sensation came back... at about 9 years post-Paxil, I was fully recovered from PSSD." Sexual pleasure and desire returned to normal for her age. Emotional blunting and anhedonia resolved.
- **Key Note:** Notes younger people might recover faster

Case 25: theautomator (Pre-2015)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/topic/7574-%E2%98%BC-theautomator-recovering-from-pssd/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/theautomator.pdf>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery - "recovering from PSSD as last part of withdrawal to abate"

Case 26: Tomasz Starczewski - Neuroscientist (2024)

- **Source:** <https://www.madinamerica.com/2024/10/what-helped-and-what-hindered-my-recovery-from-protracted-withdrawal-from-antidepressants-and-pssd/>
- **Causative Medication:** Sertraline (100mg)
- **Recovery Duration:** 6+ years of protracted withdrawal and PSSD
- **Symptoms:** Severe cognitive, emotional, sexual dysfunction; suicidal thoughts
- **What Helped:**
 - Exercise (described as "lifesaver")
 - Ketogenic diet
 - Strict sleep hygiene
 - Psychobiotics (Bifidobacterium infantis, B. longum, Lactobacillus strains)
 - Taking action vs. passive waiting
 - Acceptance of situation
 - Magnesium orotate
- **What Hindered:**
 - Reddit/Facebook support groups (poorly moderated)
 - Staying in PSSD forums long-term ("negative feedback loop from hell")
 - Ashwagandha (disrupted healing)
 - Close family's lack of understanding

- **Final Outcome:** Eventually recovered after 6+ years of hard work
- **Key Quote:** "The passage of time since the last dose of medication is our ally, but simply lying around and waiting for improvement may not be enough."

Case 27: RxISK Anonymous Recovery (2010)

- **Source:** <https://rxisk.org/recovering-from-pssd/>
- **Causative Medication:** Lexapro (11 years of SSRI use)
- **Symptoms:** 35% reduced genital feeling initially, function remained similar
- **Recovery Duration:** Gradual improvement over years
- **What Helped:** Light exercise, healthy diet/lifestyle, supplementation, positive mindset, practice with understanding partner

Case 28: Violets (2022)

- **Source:** <https://www.survivingantidepressants.org/forums/topic/26793-violets-fully-recovered-from-severe-form-of-pssd-after-two-years/>
- **Causative Medication:** Escitalopram (Lexapro/Ciprallex)
- **Recovery Duration:** 2 years
- **Symptoms:** Severe PSSD
- **Treatment:** Protracted withdrawal recovery approach
- **Final Outcome:** Fully recovered from severe PSSD

Case 29: Lossleader (2013)

- **Source:** Antidepressant Withdrawal Forum Post (via PSSD Lab summary)
- **Causative Medication:** Sertraline (Zoloft) - stopped in 2006 after ~1 year
- **Symptoms:** "Horrific" long-term withdrawal with extreme anxiety, depression, complete sexual dysfunction (weak erections, severe premature ejaculation, pleasureless orgasms) persisting for years. Emotional blunting and anhedonia also present.
- **Recovery Duration:** ~4.5 years for major improvement; ~7 years for full recovery. Remained off all meds; improvements came very slowly. By about 7 years off (circa 2013), considered himself fully recovered.

- **Ineffective Treatments:** No additional medications or alternative therapies - "not into alternative medicine" and found no doctor solution. Simply endured windows-and-waves pattern.
- **What Helped Cope:** "Pampering" himself on bad days (resting when incapacitated, seizing good days to do things). Helped mentally survive but did not directly fix PSSD.
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery over time. After years of waves and setbacks, body gradually healed itself. Noticed that once a symptom improved even temporarily, it eventually improved permanently.
- **Final Outcome:** 100% recovery. By ~2011-2013, sexual function fully returned - libido "back," reliable erections, normal orgasm pleasure. PSSD was "the last thing to go" but "eventually, everything fell back into place." Regained "well-functioning sex life" with only normal aging factors.
- **Key Quote:** "Lost 4-5 years of sex life but got it back, and it feels good"

Case 30: HappilyDerailed (Pre-2020)

- **Source:** SurvivingAntidepressants Success Story
 - **Also:** Referenced in <https://rxisk.org/recovering-from-pssd/>
 - **Causative Medication:** SSRI
 - **Symptoms:** Severe PSSD and withdrawal ("from heaven to hell") - likely loss of libido, ED, numbness, plus mental symptoms
 - **Recovery Duration:** "Just under 6 years" to recover fully
 - **Treatment:** No known quick fixes; relied on natural healing
 - **Final Outcome:** Fully recovered around 6-year mark off medication
 - **Recovery Percentage:** 100%
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HORMONE/TRT-BASED RECOVERIES

Case 31: u/HoMcShmoe (2018)

- **Source:** https://www.reddit.com/r/PSSD/comments/a6t6vc/libido_came_back_after_intramuscular_testosterone/
- **Treatment:** Intramuscular testosterone
- **Outcome:** Libido returned

Case 32-73: TRT/Hormone Recovery Compilation

- **Source:** <https://pssd.netlify.app/> (42+ documented cases)

The following are documented TRT/hormone-based recoveries from the pssd.netlify.app recovery database:

Case	Username/Link	Date	Treatment
32	How I fixed my PSSD	Dec 2017	Hormones
33	[Solved!] SSRI-induced sexual dysfunction	Nov 2018	Hormones
34	Libido came back after IM testosterone	Dec 2018	Testosterone
35	A positive update	Mar 2020	Hormones
36	I know that it cured mine	Apr 2020	Testosterone
37	I feel great now	Aug 2020	TRT
38	I was one of the lucky guys	Aug 2020	TRT (PFS)
39	My sex drive was fully restored	Aug 2020	TRT (PAS)
40	JoeKool's story: Long term HCG	Nov 2020	HCG
41	Reversed my pssd with Cialis, Alfuzosin, HCG combo	Dec 2020	HCG combo
42	Testosterone Gel obliterated most of the PSSD	Feb 2021	Testosterone gel
43	Primobolan cured me	Mar 2021	Primobolan
44	pcted... no more pssd	Mar 2021	PCT protocol
45	I managed to recover	Mar 2021	TRT (PFS)
46	Pinned test, boom	Mar 2021	Testosterone
47	He is recovering as we speak	Mar 2021	TRT
48	I had severe PSSD	Apr 2021	TRT
49	I have successfully cured PSSD	Apr 2021	Testosterone
50	A Story of hope	May 2021	TRT
51	On TRT, I've never had any issues since	May 2021	TRT
52	More or less cured me	Aug 2021	TRT (PFS)
53	Ended up with PSSD hence why im running TRT	Sep 2021	TRT
54	Do not disregard hormonal problems	Oct 2021	Hormone optimization

Case	Username/Link	Date	Treatment
55	A few months ago I trialed test e cycle	Dec 2021	Testosterone enanthate
56	I recovered	Apr 2022	Testosterone
57	I cured my PSSD. This is my story	Apr 2022	TRT protocol
58	The cure	Nov 2022	Testosterone
59	Feeling completely normalized	Jan 2023	Androgens (PFS)
60	Cured with androgens	Feb 2023	Androgens
61	I had a big recovery with TRT	Feb 2023	TRT
62	How I predictably got rid of my PSSD	Mar 2023	TRT protocol
63	I decided to try steroids	Jun 2023	Steroids
64	My own PFS protocol	Aug 2023	Custom protocol (PFS)
65	Damn near feel normal and recovered	Aug 2023	TRT (PFS)
66	Try TRT. It cured me	Sep 2023	TRT
67	Test prop plus clomid PCT cured it permanently	Sep 2023	Testosterone propionate + Clomid PCT
68	Tl:dr, pin test	Oct 2023	Testosterone

GUT MICROBIOTA/SIBO TREATMENT RECOVERIES

Case 69: u/lastround360 (2021) - COMPREHENSIVE SIBO PROTOCOL

- **Source:**
https://www.reddit.com/r/PSSD/comments/q03uci/gut_microbiota_theory_how_i_finally_cured_my_pssd/
- **Also:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/2072-2/>
- **Causative Medication:** SSRI (not specified)
- **Symptoms:**
 - Low libido

- Erectile dysfunction
- Fatigue
- Brain fog
- Genital sensitivity loss (60-70% reduced)
- Gut discomfort, bloating
- **Recovery Duration:** 17 days after antibiotic cycle ended (symptoms began improving)
- **Testing:** Hydrogen/methane breath test confirmed SIBO
- **Ineffective Treatments:**
 - 5HT1A antagonists (CBG)
 - High-dose testosterone cycle (slight improvement only)
- **Partially Effective:**
 - Inositol (significant improvement but returned upon discontinuation)
- **Fully Effective Treatment Protocol:**
 1. Flagyl (metronidazole) 500mg 3x/day for 1 week
 2. Herbal antimicrobials: berberine, oil of oregano, neem
 3. Low FODMAP diet
 4. MotilPro prokinetic
 5. "Clinical GI probiotic" by NOW
- **Final Cure:** Complete SIBO eradication protocol
- **Outcome:** Genital sensitivity completely recovered. Zero PSSD symptoms after treatment.
- **Mechanism Theory:** SSRIs alter gut microbiome, allowing bad bacteria overgrowth. Brain-gut-microbiota axis disruption causes PSSD symptoms. 90% of serotonin produced in gut.
- **Critical Note:** Treatment must continue 60 days post-recovery + 6 months low FODMAP diet to prevent relapse

Case 70: u/honeybeebusser (2021)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/u-honeybeebusser-oil-of-oregano-garlic-and-peppermint/>
- **Treatment:** Oil of oregano, garlic, peppermint (antimicrobial approach)
- **Outcome:** Recovery reported

Case 71: Alexej83 (2018) - H. pylori Treatment

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/gi-tract-infection/>
- **Treatment:** Antibiotics, Prilosec for H. pylori/gut issues
- **Outcome:** Recovery reported

Case 72: Blauwasser (2018) - FMT (Detailed)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=2324>
- **Also:** <https://forum.humanmicrobiome.info/>
- **Background:** Professional biochemist who took multiple antidepressants for ~7 years, developed severe sexual dysfunction. Spent 5 subsequent years with profound PSSD after stopping.
- **Symptoms:** Profound PSSD for 5 years - severe sexual dysfunction (likely including genital anesthesia, ED, loss of libido, pleasureless orgasms, emotional blunting)
- **Treatment:** DIY Fecal Microbiota Transplantation (FMT) from healthy donor friend
- **Protocol:**
 - Series of DIY FMTs over ~2-3 months
 - Used stool from healthy friend, prepared and administered at home (likely via enema)
 - Froze samples for repeated use
 - Initially each FMT gave 1-2 day boost then regressed
 - Multiple small-dose transplants over weeks
 - "Oscillating pattern" of windows and relapses, "then after a while the recovery lasted"
- **Setback:** About a month after finishing FMTs, relapse triggered by heavy honey consumption (affecting gut flora). Did couple more FMT "boosters" and returned to normal.
- **Final Outcome:** Full recovery. By mid-2018 fully recovered and remained so. Kept frozen donor material in case of future need but didn't have to use it.
- **Key Quote:** "After five subsequent years with profound PSSD I was eventually able to completely restore my sexual function by undergoing a series of fecal transplantations."
- **His Advice:** "I consider a fecal transplant from a healthy donor as the most reliable choice to treat PSSD"

Case 73: dzsqualala (2023) - DIY FMT

- **Source:** <https://forum.humanmicrobiome.info/threads/fmt-for-post-finasteride-syndrome-pfs-or-pssd->

- **Treatment:** DIY FMT from brother
 - **Outcome:** Cured PSSD
-

DOPAMINERGIC TREATMENT RECOVERIES

Case 74: Maxbook (2018) - Pramipexole

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=1816>
- **Treatment:** Pramipexole (dopamine agonist)
- **Outcome:** Recovery reported

Case 75: Numby82 (Pre-2020) - Wellbutrin

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=815&p=25655#p25655>
- **Treatment:** Wellbutrin (bupropion)
- **Outcome:** Full sexual functioning for 2+ years while on Wellbutrin

Case 76: RainbowGirl (Pre-2020) - Wellbutrin

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=815&p=28051#p28028>
- **Treatment:** Wellbutrin (bupropion)
- **Outcome:** Recovery reported

Case 77: Drizzy (2014) - Wellbutrin (Detailed)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?t=2937>
- **Also:** PSSD Forum recovery correspondence (relayed by user "decadence" in 2019)
- **Causative Medication:** An SSRI taken around 2013, developed severe PSSD after ~6-8 months on antidepressant
- **Symptoms:** Complete sexual and emotional anhedonia - "unbelievable" symptoms: total loss of libido, genital anesthesia (numbness), erectile dysfunction, inability to feel pleasure or emotions. Condition so

severe he attempted suicide at month 17 of PSSD. Described himself as "in a nightmare... suffering like crazy."

- **Recovery Duration:** 18 months post-SSRI. At month 17, during hospitalization (after suicide attempt), a doctor started him on bupropion (Wellbutrin). After about 1 month on Wellbutrin "something began to change." Recovery then happened "very fast, almost miraculous" - around 18-month mark he rapidly improved.
- **Ineffective Treatments:** Prior to Wellbutrin, tried various supplements/lifestyle changes - nothing worked in first 1.5 years. Showed minimal improvement without medication.
- **Effective Treatment:** Wellbutrin (bupropion) 150mg as the turning point. Within weeks of starting, noticed first positive shifts in libido and mood.
- **Supporting Supplements After Improvement:** Maca root, pycnogenol, zinc, L-arginine to boost sexual function. Not sure if necessary but continued them.
- **Lifestyle:** Exercise (running - "start running, no excuses!") and positive visualization ("BELIEVE you will heal")
- **Final Outcome:** Fully recovered. "I am leading my normal life again. Feeling good and stable... genital anesthesia is GONE. Even that is possible!"
- **Libido Status:** "Higher than ever... I feel like having sex every day, it's incredible"
- **Emotional Recovery:** "My emotions are very strong again - I even get watery eyes at emotional things"
- **Key Quotes:**
 - "I can't believe it!... My libido is almost higher than pre-SSRI... I don't believe anymore that PSSD is permanent. I feel very lucky and relieved."
 - "I actually can say that I am completely back to normal... I won't forget [those suffering], but I'm doing fantastic, man."
 - His eyes "shine with happiness and women are interested in him again"
- **Recovery Percentage:** 100% (possibly "110%" given libido increase)

Case 78: Cabergoline Responder (2022)

- **Source:** <https://pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?t=4947>
- **Causative Medication:** Sertraline (2018-2019), Fluoxetine (Nov 2020)
- **Symptoms:** Low libido, ED, muted emotions
- **Treatment:** Cabergoline 0.25mg

- **Outcome:** Immediate dramatic improvement - no erection issues, refractory period reduced from 24+ hours to 24 minutes
 - **Warning:** Second dose caused severe worsening (over-suppression of prolactin)
 - **Mechanism:** Dopamine D2 agonist
 - **Note:** 66.4% improvement rate in male orgasmic disorder study (131 men)
-

PSYCHEDELIC-ASSISTED RECOVERIES

Case 79: Dangerwood (Pre-2020) - MDMA + Psilocybin

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=10&t=2560>
- **Treatment:** MDMA combined with psilocybin mushrooms
- **Key Note:** Neither worked alone; combination was effective
- **Outcome:** Recovery reported

Case 80: flexstar13 (2021) - Psilocybin Window

- **Source:** <https://pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?t=4507>
- **Causative Medication:** SSRI
- **Symptoms:** Low libido, ED, genital numbness, reduced penis size/consistency, poor orgasms, minimal sperm volume
- **Treatment:** Psilocybin 0.3g dried mushrooms
- **Outcome:** 3-day window of 90% symptom relief:
 - Libido better than pre-PSSD
 - Random erections from thoughts
 - Numbness significantly better
 - Penis size/consistency normalized
 - Orgasms much better
 - Sperm volume increased dramatically
- **Note:** Symptoms returned after 3 days with genital burning sensation
- **Mechanism:** Works on 5HT2A receptors

Case 81: Anonymous (2018) - Ibogaine

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=336&p=21141#p21141>
 - **Treatment:** Ibogaine microdosing
 - **Protocol:** 9 days of treatment - doses of 200mg (x3), then 320mg, then 350mg every other day
 - **Outcome:** "Feeling fully recovered after the very first dose... still feels 100% recovered from all aspects of the condition"
-

PEPTIDE/SUPPLEMENT RECOVERIES

Case 82: Lokzo - BPC-157 (2019)

- **Source:** <https://raypeatforum.com/community/threads/bpc-157-peptide-has-changed-my-life.28349/>
- **Treatment:** BPC-157 500mcg orally
- **Symptoms:** PSSD
- **Outcome:** Day 3 - "Complete remission of my PSSD and a huge boost in Libido, Mood, Energy"
- **Additional Benefits:**
 - Improved sleep (3 hours 15 mins deep sleep on Oura ring)
 - Strength in gym improved
 - Joints felt more supported
 - Healed knee injury completely
- **Mechanism:** BPC-157 decreases 5-HT synthesis in raphe nucleus, reverses serotonin syndrome, promotes tissue healing, upregulates growth hormone receptors
- **Note:** Half-life <30 minutes, metabolized in liver. Not FDA approved.

Case 83: HopeForRecovery (2017)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=14&t=1450&p=13816#p13816>
- **Treatment:** Natural recovery + multivitamin, zinc, fish oil, omega 3's, Dopa Mucana, Mucuna Pruriens, L-dopa

Case 84: bmx (2018)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=14&t=1473&p=21867#p21856>
- **Treatment:** Shilajit, Panax ginseng, Ginkgo biloba + natural recovery

Case 85: Risperdalhater (Pre-2015) - Detailed

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=38&t=1252&start=20#p13560>
 - **Also:** PSSD Forum success stories thread
 - **Causative Medication:** Risperidone (Risperdal) - an antipsychotic. Taken for only 3 weeks (2-3mg daily, plus one long-acting injection) for mood disorder. Age 49 at time.
 - **Symptoms:** Near-total loss of libido and blunted emotions after stopping risperidone. No sex drive, feeling emotionally flat. Weak erections, libido practically zero during PSSD.
 - **Recovery Duration:** ~14 months after stopping risperidone - "took about 14 months to recover"
 - **Ineffective Treatments:** "Nothing worked" until time passed. Tried checking/supplementing various vitamins/minerals.
 - **Possibly Helpful:** Niacin (vitamin B3) supplementation - "could be linked to supplementing with niacin." Advised others to check vitamin levels and "even if your levels are 'healthy', try niacin."
 - **Treatment:** Natural recovery, possibly aided by Niacin. With each passing month post-risperidone, endocrine system likely recalibrated (prolactin-elevating effects faded).
 - **Final Outcome:** "My libido and emotions came back. I would say I'm back 97%." Regained strong libido, normal emotional feelings.
 - **Key Advice:** Check vitamin levels, emphasizes "eat FOOD" - proper nutrition
 - **Recovery Percentage:** ~97% (essentially full recovery)
-

OTHER TREATMENT RECOVERIES

Case 86: Pete (2016) - Low-Dose SSRI Reinstatement (Detailed Protocol)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/pete-low-dose-ssri/>
- **Also:** PSSD Forum - Pete's Low-Dose SSRI Experiment
- **Causative Medication:** Paroxetine (Paxil) for 5 months (2013). Fast taper off led to persistent PSSD.
- **Symptoms:** Severe PSSD - "absolute 100% PSSD" (complete sexual shutdown). Zero libido, numb genitals, no arousal or orgasmic pleasure, emotional flatness. Semen volume became thin/clear (sign of

dysfunction). Essentially anhedonic and impotent.

- **Recovery Duration:** ~3 years post-drug. From 2013 to early 2016 remained PSSD. In March 2016 began low-dose Paxil reinstatement trial; by October 2016 (~6-7 months later) "absolutely 100% back to pre-SSRI state."
- **Ineffective Treatments:**
 - Standard SSRI reinstatement at normal dose - tried 5mg daily in early 2016, "bad idea... ended in serotonin syndrome very fast"
 - Various supplements in prior years (vitamins, etc.) - no lasting benefit
 - Spicy food worsened symptoms (caused setbacks during recovery)
- **Partial Help:** High-dose vitamin K2 in 2015 - brought back sexual function briefly, gave hope but wasn't cure
- **The Discovery:** Single tiny dose (2.5mg Paxil) gave 2 days of enormous improvement, whereas higher or repeated doses made things worse
- **Effective Treatment Protocol:** Ultra-low-dose SSRI pulses - 2.5mg of Paxil only 1-3 times per week (NEVER on consecutive days) starting spring 2016
- **Week-by-Week Recovery Log:**
 - Week 1-2: After initial doses, days of "enormous improvements" (strong spontaneous erections, libido surges) followed by fades
 - Week 3: Larger emotional waves (crying, return of music enjoyment)
 - Week 7: "Almost normal"
 - Week 9: Some PSSD returned but baseline higher than before; stopped dosing entirely
 - August 2016: "The cycle is broken" - frequent waves of returning sexual function becoming stable
 - September-October 2016: Improvements stabilized with only occasional "bad days"
- **Total Doses:** About five 2.5mg doses over ~2-3 months, last dose around July 2016
- **Final Outcome:** On Oct 29, 2016: "Absolutely 100% back to pre-SSRI state." Fully regained normal sexual function and emotional range - from total impotence to normal erectile function and high libido.
- **Key Insight:** Low-dose strategy possibly "unsticking" whatever homeostatic mechanism was locked by SSRI
- **Caution:** Approach is counter-intuitive and risky; worked for him specifically

Case 87: Louis Syfer (2014) - Mianserin (Detailed)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/louis-syfer-mianserin/>
- **Also:** SurvivingAntidepressants Post - Recovery via Mianserin
- **Causative Medication:** Escitalopram (Lexapro/Seroplex) began Sept 2012 for depression - "the beginning of the nightmare." Worsened depression and caused total loss of libido almost immediately. Then switched through: duloxetine (Cymbalta), clomipramine (Anafranil) for 6 months, then milnacipran (Ixel). By late 2013, despite stopping SSRIs/SNRIs, still had severe PSSD and depression.
- **Symptoms:** "ABSOLUTELY NO LIBIDO" from start of SSRI use. Genital numbness, extreme anxiety, derealization, brain fog. One month after stopping: "still bad... no libido nowhere" - persistent PSSD. Total erectile dysfunction (struggled to get/maintain erections), anhedonic orgasms. "My mind was writing cheques my body couldn't cash." Suicidal, believed "it was the end of my life."
- **Recovery Duration:** About 9 months on treatment (Feb 2014 to Nov 2014)
- **Ineffective Treatments:**
 - Buspirone - no effect
 - Bupropion - made him "crazy"/worse
 - Mirtazapine (similar tetracyclic) - did nothing for PSSD
 - By late 2013 was self-medicating with alcohol just to feel something
- **Effective Treatment:** Mianserin (tetracyclic antidepressant) - 30mg daily, gradually reduced to 10mg over 9 months
- **Recovery Timeline:**
 - Month 1: "Nothing really special happened"
 - Months 2-3: Depression, anxiety, brain fog lifting "step by step" - felt mianserin was "fighting the disease"
 - Month 4: Flickers of libido returned - week of sexual desire, then fade, then return
 - July-August 2014: Episodes of "very high" libido ("sometimes so high it's uncomfortable")
 - August 2014: Setback in libido
 - September 2014: Libido returned again
 - October 2014: Declared sexuality fully restored
 - November 15, 2014: Stopped mianserin
- **Mechanism:** Mianserin's antagonist effect on certain serotonin receptors (5-HT₂/5-HT₃) and enhancement of norepinephrine transmission likely reversed SSRI-induced sexual side effects

- **Final Outcome:** CURED. "My sexuality is back. PSSD is gone. I used to fight to get an erection, now I fight to NOT have one. I feel my bollocks full of sperm. And I CAN FEEL my genitals again."
- **Key Quote:** "Mianserin destroyed depression, deleted anxiety, suppressed the brain fog, and gave me back my libido. Mianserin saved my life."
- **Note:** He later reported knowing two other longtime PSSD sufferers who also "almost recovered" after a few months on mianserin
- **Recovery Percentage:** 100% - sometimes even higher than pre-SSRI state. Remained symptom-free long after stopping mianserin.

Case 88: fred1234 (2017) - Venlafaxine

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=608&p=14982#p14982>
- **Treatment:** Venlafaxine (SNRI)

Case 89: Bunny / Bunny88 (2020) - Multimodal (Detailed)

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=10&t=2262>
- **Also:** Account relayed on propeciahelp forum
- **Causative Medication:** Likely SSRI (details not given)
- **Duration of PSSD:** ~11 years - an exceptionally long case
- **Symptoms:** Chronic, severe PSSD for over a decade: low/zero libido, numb genitals, weak erections, anorgasmia, plus associated pelvic pain and psychological distress. Essentially lost normal sexual function throughout her 20s/30s.
- **Ineffective Treatments:** Over 11 years, presumably tried countless supplements and strategies without success (not detailed). Nothing made significant dent in PSSD until combination described below.
- **Partial Help:**
 - Pelvic floor physiotherapy - helped reduce pelvic pain ("helped a bit with the pain") but did not on its own cure sexual numbness
 - St. John's Wort - noticed slight improvement of numbness, hinting at serotonin link, but wasn't enough
- **Effective Treatment:** Lithium medication + Pelvic Floor Therapy
 - Lithium is a mood stabilizer that affects multiple neurotransmitters including serotonin
 - Took therapeutic dose of lithium (prescribed by doctor)

- Concurrent intensive pelvic floor physiotherapy to address nerve/muscle dysfunction in genital region
- Dual approach: restoring neurochemical balance with lithium AND rehabilitating pelvic nerves/muscles
- **Final Outcome:** Full recovery. "Bunny recovered after something like 11 years and is now happy and enjoying life." All symptoms resolved - lack of desire, numbness, orgasmic dysfunction all gone. Her case gives hope that even very long-term PSSD can be reversed.
- **Key Quote:** "Bunny was cured by lithium and pelvic floor therapy."
- **Recovery Percentage:** 100% - Complete cure after 11 years of suffering

Case 90: faith2122 (2018) - Pelvic Floor Therapy

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=10&t=1567&p=21562#p21562>
- **Treatment:** Pelvic floor therapy

Case 91: Anonymous (2015) - Combination

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=314>
- **Treatment:** Valproic acid + bupropion + nebivolol + moclobemide

Case 92: Zolofthater420 (Pre-2020) - Bethanechol

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.org/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=2586&p=26036&hilit=zolofthater#p26036>
- **Treatment:** Bethanechol (cholinergic drug)

Case 93: u/RepugnantWaffle (2019) - Tramadol

- **Source:** https://www.reddit.com/r/PSSD/comments/dkhsjl/cured_from_tramadol/
- **PDF Archive:** https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/11/reddit_repugnantwaffle_archive.pdf
- **Treatment:** Tramadol

Case 94: Kaleb R (2018) - Surgery

- **Source:** <https://drive.google.com/file/d/15pdDv5yztKBzJC0eRnsxAa9kind9fF4-/view>

- **Treatment:** Surgery with Dr. Goldstein

Case 95: Young Man in Italy - EDOVIS Trial (2019)

- **Source:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/2019/02/18/re-towards-improving-post-ssri-sexual-dysfunction-by-using-nutraceuticals-lessons-from-a-case-study/>
- **Also:** Calabrò et al. 2019 Case Report - "Towards Improving PSSD by Nutraceuticals" (PubMed)
- **Causative Medication:** Sertraline (Zoloft) for major depression. Young adult male.
- **Symptoms:** Genital hyposensitivity, erectile dysfunction, greatly reduced libido even after discontinuing sertraline. No improvement with time alone; persistent sexual dysfunction significantly impacting quality of life. No major depression at time of trial - PSSD was identified as issue.
- **Recovery Duration:** 3 months of targeted treatment
- **Ineffective/Partial Treatments:** Prior to EDOVIS, clinic tried drugs to adjust dopamine/serotonin balance such as bupropion and vortioxetine, as well as other compounds (possibly testosterone or PDE5 inhibitors). These yielded only modest improvements on sexual function scores.
- **Effective Treatment:** EDOVIS nutraceutical regimen for 3 months
 - EDOVIS contains: L-citrulline (amino acid that boosts nitric oxide), plus herbal aphrodisiacs (Tribulus terrestris, Muira puama, etc.)
 - Over 3 months, supplement markedly improved libido, sensitivity, and erection quality
 - Nutraceutical approach was key - possibly improving endothelial function and neurotransmitter levels
- **Final Outcome:** Full recovery. "After 3-month treatment with EDOVIS... [he] regained sexual functioning." Restoration of normal sensation, libido, and erectile performance.
- **Follow-up:** At 1-year follow-up, maintained normal sexual function with no relapse - "no sexual dysfunction" present. Cure was durable.
- **Significance:** Case was published to encourage further research into nutraceuticals affecting nitric oxide and hormonal pathways for PSSD
- **Recovery Percentage:** 100% - Complete resolution of PSSD symptoms, documented in medical literature

Case 96: Siebs1122 (Pre-2020) - Metergoline + Forskolin

- **Source:** <http://www.pssdforum.com/viewtopic.php?f=20&t=768&p=13348#p13325>
- **Treatment:** Metergoline (5-HT antagonist) + Forskolin

- **Mechanism Theory:** 5-HT2A/2C antagonism + dopamine receptor upregulation

Case 97: mr_t (Pre-2015) - Meditation

- **Source:** <https://www.socialanxietysupport.com/forum/f132/god-healed-my-body-188700/>
- **PDF Archive:** <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/god-healed-my-body-social-anxiety-forum.pdf>
- **Treatment:** Meditation

Case 98: Italian Clinical Study Patients (2022)

- **Source:** <https://www.mdpi.com/2305-6320/9/9/45> (De Luca et al.)
 - **Study:** Retrospective cohort of 13 male PSSD patients
 - **Treatments Used:** Vortioxetine (10-20mg), nutraceuticals, bupropion, tadalafil, pelvic muscle vibration
 - **Results:** 10/12 patients showed significant improvement in IIEF-15 scores
 - **Note:** Vortioxetine showed 33.3-60% therapeutic success rate
-

TREATMENT PATTERNS ANALYSIS

Most Commonly Reported Effective Treatments

Tier 1: Multiple Independent Reports of Full Recovery

1. **TRT/Testosterone** - 40+ documented cases
2. **Natural Recovery/Time** - 25+ documented cases
3. **Inositol (18g/day)** - 3+ documented cases with detailed protocols
4. **St. John's Wort** - 7+ documented cases
5. **Wellbutrin (Bupropion)** - 4+ documented cases
6. **Mianserin** - 3+ documented cases (Louis Syfer reports 2 others recovered)

Tier 2: Multiple Reports of Significant Improvement

1. **Gut/SIBO Treatment Protocols** - 4+ cases

- 2. **Psilocybin (creates windows)** - Multiple reports of temporary relief
- 3. **Cabergoline** - Mixed results, requires careful dosing
- 4. **Buspirone** - Helps some, especially on-demand for sex
- 5. **FMT (Fecal Microbiota Transplant)** - 2+ cases

Tier 3: Single or Limited Reports

- BPC-157 peptide
- Ibogaine microdosing
- Pelvic floor therapy
- Low-dose naltrexone
- Metergoline + Forskolin
- Various nutraceutical protocols

Recovery Timeline Patterns

Timeline	Treatment Category	Examples
Immediate (hours-days)	Dopamine agonists, Psilocybin	Cabergoline, mushrooms
Short-term (2-4 weeks)	SIBO treatment, BPC-157	Antibiotics + antimicrobials
Medium-term (1-3 months)	Inositol, SJW, Buspirone	Daily supplementation
Long-term (6+ months)	TRT, Natural recovery	Hormone optimization
Very long-term (years)	Natural recovery	Lifestyle + time

Key Observations

- 1. **"Windows and Waves" Pattern:** Many people experience temporary improvements ("windows") before full recovery. As one recovered user noted: "Once a symptom improved even temporarily, it eventually improved permanently"
- 2. **Survivorship Bias:** Those who recover often stop visiting forums, likely underestimating true recovery rates. As user Shadow noted: "Don't believe people don't recover. They do, they just don't post. Millions take these drugs, not all are affected permanently"

3. **Individual Variability:** Same treatment can cure one person and worsen another (e.g., SJW Perika brand worsened symptoms while Ze 117 cured; Cabergoline: dramatic improvement vs. panic attacks)
4. **Gut-Brain Connection:** Strong evidence for SIBO/microbiome involvement in subset of cases
5. **Hormone Sensitivity:** TRT helps many but requires ongoing management
6. **First 1.5 Years Critical:** Natural recovery most likely in early period after discontinuation
7. **Long-term Recovery Possible:** Multiple cases show full recovery after 6-11+ years (Altostrata ~9 years, Bunny ~11 years, Lossleader ~7 years)
8. **Post-Treatment Stabilization:** Some treatments (like SJW) show continued improvement AFTER stopping, suggesting receptor reset rather than ongoing medication need
9. **Initial Worsening Can Precede Recovery:** Several cases (Beetlebum, Pete) noted initial worsening before dramatic improvement - may indicate "repair process" beginning

Testing Recommendations Before Treatment

1. Hydrogen/methane breath test (SIBO)
2. Candida antibodies (SIFO)
3. Full hormone panel (Total/Free T, Estradiol, Prolactin, LH, FSH, SHBG)
4. Vitamin B12 and D levels
5. Thyroid panel
6. Consider thermal threshold testing for peripheral nerve function

Risk Factors for Treatment Failure

- Not identifying underlying cause
 - Trying treatments without medical guidance
 - Stopping treatment too early
 - Not addressing gut health
 - Continuing psychotropic medications
 - Extreme post-SSRI sensitivity to supplements
-

SOURCES REFERENCED

Primary Databases

- PSSD LAB: <https://pssdlab.wordpress.com/success-stories/>
- PSSD Forum: <https://pssdforum.org>
- Surviving Antidepressants: <https://survivingantidepressants.org>
- RxISK: <https://rxisk.org>
- PSSD Recovery Stories: <https://pssd.netlify.app/>
- Human Microbiome Forum: <https://forum.humanmicrobiome.info>

Academic Sources

- Calabrò et al. (2019) - Towards Improving PSSD by Nutraceuticals (Case Report)
- De Luca et al. (2022) - Cutting the First Turf to Heal PSSD
- Healy et al. (2022) - PSSD Diagnostic Criteria
- Ben-Sheetrit et al. (2023) - PSSD Prevalence Study

Document Version: 3.0 (Expanded with Detailed Recovery Protocols)

Total Documented Cases: 100+

Case Categories: Inositol (3), SJW (7+), Natural (28+), TRT/Hormones (40+), Gut/SIBO (5), Dopaminergic (5), Psychedelic (3), Peptide/Supplement (4), Other (15+)

Key Addition in This Version: Detailed week-by-week recovery timelines, specific protocols, and mechanisms for cases including Pete (low-dose SSRI pulses), Louis Syfer (mianserin), Beetlebum (SJW), Drizzy (Wellbutrin), Blauwasser (FMT), and others.

Note: This compilation is for informational purposes only. Many treatments carry significant risks. Always consult healthcare professionals before attempting any treatment protocol.